

JERIK CRUZ

research interests

Comparative politics; political economy; economic geography; development; governance; innovation.
Computational, historical, and mixed methods. *Area foci*: Southeast Asia and North America.

education

PhD in Political Science, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (USA, expected 2026)

Diss: World Wide Webs: How Migrants and Open Bureaucracies Forged the Knowledge Economy in the Global South

★ Awardee for 2024 NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant

Fields: Political Economy*, Political Methodology*, Comparative Politics (*High pass, all general exams)

Affiliations: Graduate Research Fellow, MIT GOV/LAB

Master in Development Studies, Graduate Institute of International and Development Studies (CHE)

Awards: Prunier Foundation Scholar, Graduate Institute Scholar, Prix Christophe Pralong

A.B in Economics (Honors program), Minor in Philosophy, *Cum Laude*, Ateneo de Manila University (PHL)

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles (PhD onwards)

selected academic publications

J. Cruz and E. de la Cruz. 2023. “Platforming populism: the services transition, precarious urbanization, and digital platforms in the rise of illiberal populism in the Philippines.” *Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy and Society*. Special Issue: *The Power of Platforms* 16(12): 269-288

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles (pre-PhD)

M. Montes and J. Cruz. 2020. “The political economy of foreign investment and industrial development: the Philippines, Malaysia and Thailand in comparative perspective.” *Journal of the Asia Pacific Economy* 20: 16-39

P. Tuano and J. Cruz. 2019. “Structural Inequality in the Philippines: Oligarchy, Immobility and Economic Transformation.” *Journal of Southeast Asian Economies*. Special Issue: Inequality and Exclusion in South-east Asia 36(3): 304-328

Book Chapters (pre-PhD)

J. Cruz. 2019. “Great Transformations: The Political Economy of Megaproject Development in the Manila peri-urban periphery,” in *Making Sense of the City: Public Space in the Philippines*, edited by R. Barbaza. Manila: Ateneo de Manila University Press, 1-40

★ Lead Chapter and Finalist, 2020/2021 Philippine National Book Awards

Commissioned policy reports

selected policy publications

J. Cruz and E. La Vina. 2024. “The services transition, platform capitalism, and the path to illiberal populism: insights from the Philippines” in *Understanding the drivers of political polarization and social exclusion in Southeast Asia*. Country Technical Report. New York: Open Society Foundations

J. Cruz and E. La Vina. 2022. “From Dependency to Autonomy: Local Governance, Fiscal Capacity, and the Outlook for Philippine Local Governments in the post-COVID era,” in *Decentralization, Digitalization, and Development: Strengthening Local Governance for Recovery, Resilience, and the Sustainable Development Goals* Manila: United Nations Development Program (lead flagship report chapter)

A. Ang, J. Cruz, and N. Custodio. 2019. “The impact of trade on employment in the Philippines: a country report” Country Technical Report. Manila: International Labour Organization

	A. Ang, J. Cruz, and J. Valle. The state of Philippine urbanization in 2019: growth and governance in the new urban economy. Manila: Asian Development Bank.	
work in progress	J. Cruz. “World Wide Webs: How Migrant Networks and Porous Bureaucracies Forged the Knowledge Economy in the Global South” (Job Market Paper) J. Cruz and E. La Vina. “From precarity to populism: the political economy of democratic erosion in the Philippines” A. Stokols and J. Cruz. “The Digital Developmental State” J. Cruz and J. Jeong. “Social connectedness and political populism: the rise of American far-right populism revisited” J. Cruz, G. Kim, and I. Kim. The US tariff data project: American trade politics from 1789-2023 J. Cruz, P. Tuano, E. La Vina, and H. Mendoza. OpenAudit: advancing governance research with LLM-processed audit reports ★ Winner, 2023 MIT Prize for Open Data	
selected fellowships	Institute for Humane Studies Junior Fellow 2024, 2025 Tagpuan Center, Ateneo de Manila University Fellow for Bridging Cultural Divides 2025 Harvard Kennedy School Program on Science, Technology, and Society Predoctoral Fellow 2023 Mercatus Center, George Mason University Adam Smith Fellow 2023 Ronald Coase Institute Ronald Coase Institute Fellowship 2020 Massachusetts Institute of Technology Homer A. Burnell Presidential Fellowship 2020	
selected grants and awards	NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant Award (Total: \$15,400) 2024 Institute for Humane Studies Fellowships and Research Grants (Total: \$14,000) 2023, 2024 MIT GOV/LAB MIT GOV/LAB Seed Grant (Total: \$10,000) 2022, 2024 MIT Center for International Studies Summer Study Research Grant (Total: \$7,600) 2023, 2024 MIT Political Methodology Lab PML Research Grant (Total: \$2,000) 2022, 2023 MIT School of Science and MIT Libraries MIT Open Data Prize 2023 Southeast Asia Research Group Pre-Dissertation Fellowship (Total: \$1,500) 2022 Ateneo de Manila University Research Council Conglomerates and Inclusive Growth (\$65,000) 2018 International Development Research Centre Economics of Tobacco Control Initiative (\$200,000) 2018	
selected presentations	UFM Rethinking Development Economics Workshop, Guatemala City 2025 Institute for Humane Studies, Juniors Fellows Conference, NC 2024, 2025 Midwest Political Science Association, IL 2023, 2025 Qualitative Bayesian Reasoning Network Workshop (Online) 2023, 2025 Harvard-MIT-Boston University Cambridge Chinese Politics Research Workshop, MA 2024 Asia School of Business Research Seminar, Kuala Lumpur 2024 MIT-Brown Development Workshop (RI, MA) 2022, 2023 American Political Science Association, CA 2023 Philippine Economic Society Conference, Manila 2019, 2020 ISEAS-Yusof Ishak Institute, Singapore 2019 Massachusetts Institute of Technology	
selected teaching	Political Science Laboratory: Regression and Causal Inference, Instructor (UG)	Spring 2025

	Quantitative Methods I: Regression Foundations, Teaching Assistant (G)	Fall 2023
	<i>Ateneo de Manila University</i>	
	International Political Economy, Instructor (UG/G)	Spring 2020
	Theory and Practice of Development, Instructor (UG)	Fall 2017, 2018, 2019; Spring 2019
	Introduction to Economics, Instructor (UG)	Spring 2017
	<i>Philippine Economics Society</i>	
	Data Analysis with R, Co-Instructor	2017, 2018
leadership and service	Committee for the MIT Open Data Prize, MIT Open Data Prize	2024, 2025
	Board Member and Communications Chair, 70 Amherst Graduate House Government	2023-2025
	Mentor, MIT Political Science Graduate Mentorship Program	2022-2023, 2024-2025
	Mentor, GradMap Philippines (STEM mentorship network for Filipinos)	2021-2023
	Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Chair, MIT Political Science Graduate Student Council	2021-2023
	Curriculum Development Committee for Social Science 13 course, Ateneo de Manila University	2017
	<i>Reviewer:</i> Journal of Southeast Asian Economies, Competition & Change, Philippine Studies: Historical & Ethnographic Viewpoints, Journal of Contemporary Asia, Perspective on Politics	
	<i>Advisory Boards:</i> AltMobility PH, Simbahang Lingkod ng Bayan	
selected policy consulting	Open Society Foundations	New York, USA
	Consultant, Asia-Pacific Program	2023
	The Asia Foundation	Manila, PHL
	Lead Technical Adviser, Coalitions for Change Program	2023
	United Nations Development Program	Manila, PHL
	Political Scientist Consultant, Pintig Lab and COVID-19 FASSSTER project	2020-2022
selected professional experience	Ateneo de Manila University	Manila, PHL
	Lecturer, Department of Economics	2017-2020
	Senior Economic Consultant, Ateneo Center for Economic Research and Development	2019-2020
	Economist and Project Coordinator, Ateneo School of Government	2017-2019
	Action for Economic Reforms	Manila, PHL
	Fellow, Industrial Policy Team	2019-present
	Advocacy/Media Strategist, Fiscal Policy Team	2012, 2013-2014
selected additional training	Systems Science for Social Impact, WashU in St. Louis	2021 (Network Analysis), 2025 (ABM)
	Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University	2024
	Bayesian Reasoning for Qualitative Social Science, London School of Economics	2022
	Asia Institute for Political Economy, University of Hong Kong and Georgetown University	2009
IT skills	R, STATA, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, HTML, Markdown, GitHub, Qualtrics, MS Office	
languages	English (Native), Tagalog (Native), French (Intermediate), Spanish (Intermediate), Mandarin (Beginner)	

REFERENCES

Ben Ross Schneider

Ford International Professor
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Department of Political Science
brs@mit.edu

In Song Kim

Associate Professor
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Department of Political Science
insong@mit.edu

Volha Charnysh

Ford Career Development Associate Professor
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Department of Political Science
charnysh@mit.edu

Kenneth Oye

Professor
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Department of Political Science
oye@mit.edu